

tions, even if advanced and powerful hardware is not at their disposal. Companies requiring Big Data storage and analysis use cloud computing services regularly. This runs down to online retailers, large retailers, banks, consultancies, etc.

At a smaller, somewhat micro level you have already used the cloud when you read an email, or book a ticket on an online reservation platform. Cloud computing has already taken over your online life.

This large scale expansion of Cloud Computing as a viable platform for computing has been made possible because of the entry of big players. Amazon provides a variety of cloud services ranging from storage to super-computing time. Google and Microsoft have slowly started invading the scene. Wal-Mart recently entered the market too. Then there are the old war horses such as EMC and IBM which support an array of cloud based technologies. With such companies investing, you can safely assume that Cloud Computing is here to stay.

Like any other rapidly advancing technology Cloud Computing has had its own share of drawbacks. Larry Ellison, for example, seems to really have some strong views



against cloud computing. He has gone on record to call it gibberish and insane. There have been a few reservations regarding data security and privacy. But Cloud Computing technology has admirably stood its ground. It allows small industries and enterprises to test their operations without high investments. Large companies can adapt to a better framework for their large scale data handling operations. Cloud Computing has opened up avenues in an insane number of fields. It has been the major driving force for the app revolution in the market. It has been a prime enforcer in the rise of medium and small scale computing enterprises. The cloud is growing rapidly. According to estimates the cloud will grow by 130 per cent by 2016, and the Cloud Computing industry will be worth an estimated \$150 billion. These are dizzying figures to say the least. Enough to substantiate that the cloud is a looming force. 